Rippling Removal for Windows

rippling_removal_windows.ps1 · v1.3.1 · Iru, Inc.

Removes leftover Rippling agent components from Windows devices after they have migrated to Iru. The Windows counterpart of Iru's macOS rippling_removal.sh.

Ships safe by default. As delivered, the script runs in dry-run mode — it scans, reports, and changes nothing. You must edit one line to make it act.

Quick start

STEP	WHAT TO DO
1. Dry run	Push the script as-is from the Iru console (Custom Script library item, runs as SYSTEM) to one test device.
2. Read the verdict	Open the script output in the Iru console and read the SUMMARY block at the bottom.
3. Go live	If the FOUND lines look right, change `$DryRun = $true` → `$false` and push again.
4. Restart	Restart the device to flush files Windows queued for deletion.
5. Roll out	Push live mode to the remaining devices. Safe to re-run anywhere.

The two modes

One variable controls everything (top of the script, under **Editable defaults**):

```
$DryRun = $true    # DRY RUN (default) — scan and report only. Changes NOTHING.
$DryRun = $false   # LIVE — same scan, actually removes what it finds.
```

There are no other modes. Dry run and live produce identical scans, so a dry-run report is an exact preview of what live mode will do.

What it does — three phases

Phase 1 · Assessment (read-only, runs in both modes)

Answers: "did the migration actually complete on this device?"

- Is the Iru agent present? (checks for the UEMAgent service)
- Any Rippling MDM enrollment remnants? (inspected only — never modified)
- Is the Rippling app still installed? (if yes: a restart will not fix it)
- Is a restart pending? (uninstalls queue locked files for deletion at reboot)

Phase 2 · Sweep (honors the mode switch)

In this order — the order is deliberate, see Safety below:

1. **Scheduled tasks** — incl. `Rippling-Rescuer`, the watchdog, killed first
2. **Service** — `rippling-daemon`
3. **Processes** — Rippling Tray instances
4. **Official uninstaller** — `Uninstall Rippling.exe /allusers /S`, if present
5. **Autostart entries** — Run keys (machine + every user hive)
6. **Folders** — `Program Files\Rippling`, `ProgramData\Rippling`, per-user AppData
7. **Registry** — Rippling entries under the Uninstall keys only
8. **Optional, flag-gated** — Chocolatey and the RipplingAdmin account (see flags below)

Phase 3 · Summary

Counts (found / removed / failed) plus a one-line RESULT verdict. This is the block to read in the Iru console — read the output bottom-up.

Reading the RESULT line

VERDICT	MEANING	YOUR MOVE
CLEAN	Migration already removed everything.	Nothing — restart if one is pending.
DRY RUN complete	Report only; FOUND lines = what live mode would remove.	Review, then flip `$DryRun`.
CLEANED	Live run removed everything it found.	Restart the device.
PARTIAL	Some items couldn't be removed (usually file locks).	Restart, then re-run the script.

Every line also lands in a timestamped file on the device: `C:\ProgramData\Iru\MDMMigration\Logs\rippling_removal_<timestamp>.log`

Exit codes: `0` = clean, dry run complete, or cleaned · `1` = live run with failed removals.

Optional flags (default: off)

FLAG	DEFAULT	WHAT ENABLING IT DOES	BEFORE YOU ENABLE IT
`$RemoveRipplingAdmin`	`$false`	Deletes the RipplingAdmin local admin account + its profile.	Confirm another local admin exists on the fleet. On some fleets it's the only local admin, and Iru LAPS is not yet available. Left off, the script just logs a warning.
`$RemoveChocolatey`	`$false`		

FLAG	DEFAULT	WHAT ENABLING IT DOES	BEFORE YOU ENABLE IT
		Removes Chocolatey (Rippling's app-install layer on Windows).	Confirm nobody uses choco themselves. Removal doesn't uninstall choco-installed apps — they just become unmanaged.

Both work the same in either mode and can be done later as a follow-up — nothing forces the decision on day one.

Safety design

- **Dry-run by default** — first contact with any machine is an audit, not an action.
- **Iru's enrollment cannot be harmed.** Iru's MDM enrollment lives in `HKLM\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Enrollments`; this script never writes there. Registry **key deletion** is scoped exclusively to the Uninstall records; beyond that, the script removes only individual Rippling autostart values and, if the Chocolatey flag is enabled, its environment variables.
- **Watchdog-safe ordering.** `Rippling-Rescuer` (Rippling's repair task) is removed before the service and processes it protects, so nothing resurrects mid-cleanup.
- **Every removal is verified.** After acting, the script re-checks that the item is actually gone — service queried, task re-listed, path re-tested, registry re-read — and reports FAILED if it isn't, so the summary reflects reality.
- **Idempotent.** Re-running in any mode, on any device state, is safe — devices converge to clean.
- **Out of scope, on purpose:** SentinelOne (even if delivered via Rippling) and MDM enrollments. Removing an EDR is a separate, deliberate decision.

FAQ

The dry run found 20+ items — is that bad? It means the migration's app-uninstall step didn't complete on that device (the MDM handoff can still be fine). That's exactly what this script is for. Flip to live mode.

Phase 1 says "restart pending" — should I just restart instead? Only if it also says the Rippling app is *not* installed. Then leftovers are often just files queued for deletion, and a restart clears them — the summary will tell you when that shortcut applies. If the app is still installed, restarting does nothing; run live mode.

Can I run it twice? Yes — any mode, any order, any number of times.

Why do I see "kandji" in the agent detection? Deliberate, not a branding miss: post-rebrand infrastructure still uses legacy Kandji identifiers, so the agent check matches both to avoid false "agent not detected" warnings. Explained in a comment at that line.

Version history

- **1.3.1** — Autostart Run-key and Uninstall registry-key removals now verify deletion and report FAILED when an entry survives (previously logged REMOVED unconditionally, which could

produce a false CLEANED). Chocolatey folder no longer double-counted in FOUND — dry-run and live counts now match.

- **1.3** — Artifact names corrected from the first field dry run (2026-07-13); agent detection uses word-bounded matching to avoid false positives.